

Flaw

All Scathach suffer from a bad reputation with most of their fellow nobles, as well as commoners with royalist sympathies. All Social rolls with other nobles or royalist commoners are made at a +2 difficulty; nobles from houses Liam and Danaan are exempt from this rule. By ancient pact, Gray Walkers who are Autumn sidhe or members of other kiths are also forbidden to use Sovereign, a ban backed by the full weight of the Dreaming. In general, known Scathach are typically the first investigated if notable thefts or deaths occur among the nobility, particularly if it appears to be a sophisticated or polished job.

Arcadian sidhe do not suffer the Sovereign restriction, but have trouble tempering their battle lust, requiring six successes on an extended Willpower roll (difficulty 7) to break off from combat once engaged. A botch on this roll wipes away all accumulated successes and delays a new roll for one round, and a player of a Scathach may only spend Willpower for an automatic success on this roll once per combat. While she will not blindly attack friends or bystanders in this state, she is otherwise wholly fixed on her enemies and her objectives, and will do her utmost to prevent being removed from the field until her work is done.

Exile

House Scathach was not exiled for the simple reason that only a small number of its members ever went to Arcadia in the first place. Most remained outside the gates, fading into the shadows of fae society. Unless a changeling had direct contact with them, the Gray Walkers were little more than urban legends until the Resurgence. Those few Scathach who returned from Arcadia found the house already humming along nicely in their absence, and aside from some necessary differences in philosophy and experience, there has been little friction between the two groups.

Factions & Societies

The Morphean Oracles, a secretive council of talented prophets and seasoned sorcerers whose words guide the house. The Eventide Society, warrior-diplomats who maintain contacts with various Prodigal communities in order to fight common threats. Dark Horse Investigations International, a private investigation and security company. The Seven League Knights, wanderers who protect travelers on trods and blaze new trails in the Dreaming. The Natives, a loose association of Gray Walkers who spend more time with an adopted Prodigal group – a werewolf pack, a mage cabal, etc. – than they do with other changelings.

Notable Members

As befits a small, largely apolitical house, there are few well-known Scathach, and if there is a true High Lord that stands above the Morphean Oracles, none can say. Still, even in a secretive house there are some that have made names for themselves, for better or worse. Duke Valentine, an itinerant vigilante and famed debunker of fraudulent psychics, Lady

Gear, a notorious one-eyed Shadow Court assassin, Dame Elenora Mendez, a valiant Thallain hunter from the Kingdom of the Burning Sun, and Kit, true rank unknown, a pooka of the Seven League Knights with a knack for using trods to make surgical strikes on corrupt political systems.

House Varich

(VAH-rik)

One pattern I started, now I end it to begin anew in the name of Varich, founder of the house I take as my own. May I never leave the threads of a pattern unread. May I never let a challenge go unanswered. May I never give a vow of true love to another. I give honor to House Varich and serve it with my mind, my heart, and my actions. If I forswear my oath, may all hands of my house rise against me and may the pattern of my beating heart fall to stillness forever.

Court: Unseelie

Nickname: Weavers, Puppetmasters (vulgar)

The sidhe of House Varich hail from Russia, where they were once worshipped as gods by the mortals who Dreamed and shed blood for them. Masters of pattern recognition, they followed the threads of their fellow sidhe's actions and, through that design, foresaw the Shattering. Long before the other houses had begun to flee the Earth, Varich had already returned to Arcadia with many of their vassals. For centuries, they thrived in the long Arcadian winter, finally returning to their old homeland to find it a barren waste of Banality. They immigrated to America, where they found a new home in San Francisco's Russian Hill.

Varich changelings are known for their frozen hearts and inability to love. The founder of House Varich was once betrayed in love, fooled by a sluagh sorceress into loving a magical construct made of snow. When the maiden melted away in Varich's heated embrace, Varich's parents set a curse upon the sluagh. The enmity between the sidhe of House Varich and the sluagh exists to this day, and members of House Varich vow never to give their heart to another. Varich's standard became a rallying point for the broken-hearted and betrayed, with bitterness as their banner.

House Varich doesn't fret and wait. They search for meaning in everything around them. When observing a series of seemingly-unrelated events, Varich can see the small threads that connect them, quickly learning an opponent's battle strategy, and predicting changes in politics or even the stock market, which has given Varich a great deal of financial power in the mortal world. House Varich also excels in all areas of gambling, from cards to sports betting, able to note subtle patterns in play, distinguish tells, and successfully predict outcomes.

This talent also plays out in battle, though members of this House would rather orchestrate the battle than fight it. House Varich stations officers at several key points around a battlefield to observe their foes. Once they discern the patterns governing their strategy, they reconvene and plan their attack. Those aware of Varich's ability seek to thwart it by initiating attacks before their observant enemy has a chance to learn their